



Buckingham Palace

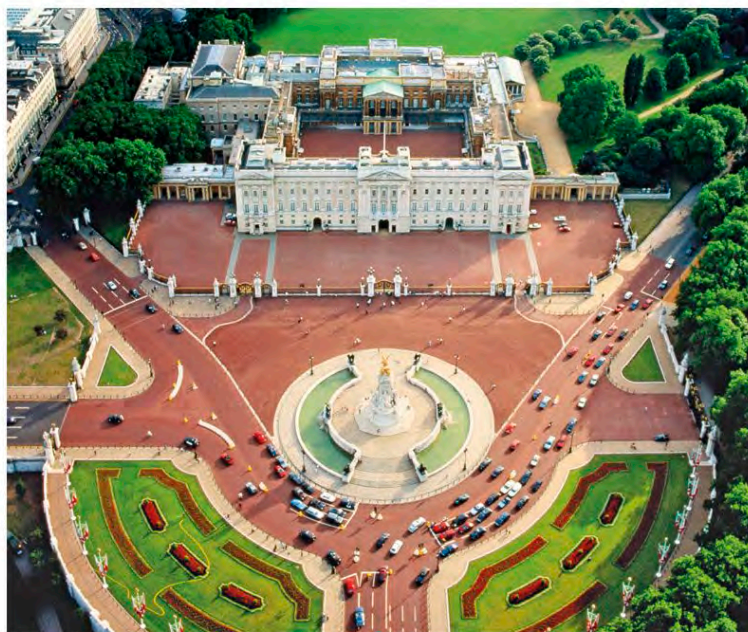
The principal London residence of the British monarchy since the time of Queen Victoria



King George III bought Buckingham House, a mansion alongside St. James's Park, in 1761 as a convenient London home for his family. In 1826, his successor, George IV, ordered architect John Nash to expand the building into a royal palace. The first monarch to occupy the new palace was Queen Victoria, after her accession in 1837.

One palace, many styles

The building has undergone many changes over time. Marble Arch, which now stands alongside Hyde Park, was originally a grand entrance to the palace courtyard. The eastern facade, with its famous balcony where the royal family appears on occasions such as weddings, did not take its current form until the early 20th century. The interior revels in a mix of styles, from Nash-designed rooms in the French Neo-Classical style to the Belle Epoque cream-and-gold decor favored by Edward VII. The state rooms are open to tourists, but the palace still serves as a royal residence, an administrative building, and a venue for official ceremonies and banquets.



◀ HUB OF THE MONARCHY

An aerial view shows Buckingham Palace facing east toward the 1911 Victoria Memorial and the Mall. The parkland to the rear and side of the building is used for royal garden parties in summer.